

The Local Awareness Channel *Audit*

Score the six static channels that turn cold locals into warm locals, and find the gap to fix first.

AUTHOR

Daris Wilson

SERIES

HMYLB · Part 2

SITE

fromthefloorup.co

WHY THIS AUDIT EXISTS

Static awareness fills your funnel while you focus on everything else.

Most local marketing dollars disappear because the audience doesn't know the business yet. Every campaign has to introduce and sell at the same time, and the math gets thin fast.

Local audiences move through three stages, cold to warm to hot. Cold is the first time someone sees your sign, your shirt, your sponsorship, or your booth. Warm is when the name starts to stick and they could pull it out of memory if a friend asked. Hot is when they need the service and your name comes up first.

Static channels do the cold-to-warm work. Signage, uniforms and merch, packaging, sponsorships, community visibility, and print presence. They run on their own without a new campaign every week, and they compound the longer you stay consistent.

This audit walks through all six channels and scores each one with four questions. The questions check whether the channel is actually moving people through the funnel, not just whether it exists. At the end, you'll have a total out of 120 and a clear sense of which channel to fix first.

How to use the audit

Score each question 1 to 5. Total each channel out of 20. Add the six channels for a total out of 120. The scorecard at the end shows the band you're in and what to do next.

WHAT YOU'RE AUDITING

The six static channels.

Each channel has a job in the funnel. Score it on whether it's doing that job, not whether it exists in some form.

#	CHANNEL	FUNNEL JOB
1	Signage	Cold people notice you, warm people see proof you work nearby.
2	Uniforms, shirts & merch	Warm people feel you're professional, and your team and customers become walking signage.
3	Packaging & take-home	Customers remember and share you, and the package travels in front of cold eyes.
4	Local sponsorships	Warm people connect you with the community and causes the audience already cares about.
5	Community visibility	Cold people meet you face-to-face, the fastest cold-to-warm channel there is.
6	Print presence	Cold people notice you, and the repetition over months turns notice into recognition.

The four questions you'll ask of every channel

1. Can people **see** your name?
2. Can they **remember** your name?
3. Do they know **what you do**?
4. Is there a clear next step to **call, visit, or book**?

A channel scores 1 to 5 on each question, totaling out of 20. Six channels add to a maximum of 120.

CHANNEL 01

Signage.

Storefront signs, branded merch, yard signs, A-frame signs, window decals, stickers, and vehicle wraps or magnets. Funnel job: cold people notice you, and warm people see proof you work nearby.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: a truck wrap that turns every job-site arrival into a moving billboard, plus a yard sign at every completed job.

Restaurant or Retail: a clean storefront sign that reads from the sidewalk, plus an A-frame on the corner Tuesday through Sunday.

Personal Service Business: a window decal at the studio, plus car magnets and a gym-bag patch at the local rec center if you're mobile.

Professional Service Business: office suite signage, branded leather portfolios, magnetic vehicle logo.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Can people **see** your signage in the places your audience actually moves?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is the signage **memorable**, with a name that sticks after one look?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the signage tell them **what you do** at a glance?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **clear next step**, like a URL, a phone number, or a directional cue?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

 / 20

CHANNEL 02

Uniforms, shirts & merch.

Polos, jackets, hats, and gear that the team wears on the job and that customers wear after the fact. Funnel job: warm people feel you're professional, and your team and customers become walking signage that puts cold people in front of your name.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: an HVAC team in matching branded polos that read as professional on the first home visit.

Restaurant or Retail: a branded ball cap regulars wear around town and a staff uniform that's photo-ready.

Personal Service Business: branded shirts on stylists or trainers, plus client gear earned through milestones the way JCF Members did.

Professional Service Business: less uniform-driven, with a branded blazer pin and tote and a branded executive portfolio.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Can people **see** your team and customers wearing your name where your audience moves?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is the uniform or merch **memorable**, recognizable across a parking lot or a sidewalk?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the gear communicate **what you do** or what you stand for?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **next step** embedded, like a website on the back, a QR on the tote, or a logo that pulls someone in?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

 / 20

CHANNEL 03

Packaging & take-home.

Branded bags, boxes, stickers on packaging, business cards in the bag, take-home guides, branded napkins, anything the customer carries out the door with your name on it. Funnel job: customers remember and share you, and the package travels in front of cold eyes long after the transaction.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: a branded folder left at the end of every job with the warranty, the next-service reminder, and a referral card.

Restaurant or Retail: a branded takeout bag that rides the bus across town at lunchtime.

Personal Service Business: a branded gift bag at the first visit with the booking link and a friend-referral card inside.

Professional Service Business: welcome packets and onboarding binders, and a leave-behind packet with engagement materials.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Can people **see** your name on what the customer carries out the door?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is the packaging **memorable**, designed well enough that the customer keeps it or shows it off?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the take-home material tell a new viewer **what you do**?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **next step** inside, like a referral card, a return-visit offer, or a clear way to book again?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

 / 20

CHANNEL 04

Local sponsorships.

Little league teams, school yearbook ads, charity 5Ks, civic events, community theater programs, and school fundraisers. Funnel job: warm people connect you with the community, and your name shows up next to causes the audience already cares about.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: sponsoring a youth baseball team with your logo on the jersey.

Restaurant or Retail: sponsoring the local high school's fall play program with a quarter-page in the playbill.

Personal Service Business: sponsoring a community 5K with a finish-line table and free water.

Professional Service Business: bar association dinners, chamber of commerce, small business expos, nonprofit galas. The sponsorship is twofold, visibility and credibility.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Can people **see** your name on the sponsorship materials and at the event itself?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is the sponsorship in a place that **connects you to a cause** your audience already cares about?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the sponsorship signal **what you do**, not just that you wrote a check?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **next step** baked in, like a booth, a discount code, or a follow-up touch?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

 / 20

CHANNEL 05

Community visibility.

Booths at farmer's markets, parades, festivals, neighborhood association meetings, civic boards, school career days, and ribbon cuttings. Outdoor presence in high-foot-traffic spots when it fits your business, the way the JCF waterfront workouts did. Funnel job: cold people meet you face-to-face, which is the fastest cold-to-warm channel there is.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: a landscaper at the spring home-and-garden expo with sample plant boards and quote slips.

Restaurant or Retail: a cafe pouring coffee at the Saturday farmer's market with a takeout flyer at the table.

Personal Service Business: a fitness coach running a 20-minute mobility class at the community center, or a salon doing braid bars at a community festival.

Professional Service Business: chamber boards, free monthly workshops, civic boards, speaking at industry events.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Are you **visible** in the places your audience already gathers, regularly enough that they expect you there?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is your presence **memorable**, with branding that reads at a distance?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the moment communicate **what you do**, ideally with a sample, demo, or conversation hook?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **next step** at the booth or after, like a sign-up sheet, a follow-up email, or a first-visit offer?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

 / 20

CHANNEL 06

Print presence.

Print ads, sponsored features, regular columns, billboards, neighborhood mailers, community magazines, church bulletins, and school newsletters. Funnel job: cold people notice you, and the repetition over months turns notice into recognition.

EXAMPLES BY CATEGORY

Home Service Business: a monthly quarter-page in the regional homeowner magazine.

Restaurant or Retail: a billboard on the route home from the office park, plus a quarterly feature in the neighborhood lifestyle publication.

Personal Service Business: a quarterly column in the community wellness magazine, plus an ad in the school yearbook every spring.

Professional Service Business: billboards, and authored columns in the local business journal.

SCORE THIS CHANNEL

1. Can people **see** your print presence in publications and locations your audience actually reads or passes?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

2. Is the print piece **memorable**, with a hook or design that lands on first read?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

3. Does the print clearly tell readers **what you do**?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

4. Is there a **next step**, like a URL, a phone number, or an offer with a deadline?

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

Channel total

--

 / 20

YOUR SCORECARD

Add the six channels.

Total your six channel scores below and find your band. Where you land tells you what to fix next.

YOUR TOTAL

/120

90 to 120

Strong foundation.

Your static layer is doing serious work. Sharpen the weakest channel and start layering dynamic.

60 to 89

Foundation taking shape.

Two or three channels are pulling weight and the rest are leaking. Pick the lowest-scoring channel and rebuild it first.

30 to 59

Gaps that compound.

Most channels are partial or invisible. Choose one to build right before adding the next, and resist running paid ads until at least two channels are above 12.

0 to 29

Start here.

Your static layer is mostly missing. Pick the highest-frequency, lowest-cost channel for your business and ship one piece of it this month.

WHAT TO FIX FIRST

The build order.

Pick one channel. Build it right. Then add the next. Three principles tell you which one to start with.

1 Highest frequency for your audience.

Pick the channel that puts your name in front of the most warm and cold eyeballs per week. A truck wrap that drives past 400 cars a day beats a billboard your audience never passes.

2 Lowest cost to ship a real version.

Real means visible, memorable, and actionable. A clean storefront sign and a packaging refresh almost always cost less than a print campaign and ship faster.

3 Lowest current score with the most upside.

Look at your scorecard. The channel scoring 4 out of 20 with a real frequency advantage is your fastest win. Rebuild it to a 15 before you touch anything else.

One thing this week

Take the channel you scored lowest with the most upside, and ship one improvement before Friday. A new yard-sign run, a redesigned takeout bag, a sponsorship signup, a uniform reorder. One channel, one week, one move.

WHAT'S NEXT

You're in the series.

The Awareness Engine is Part 2 of How to Market Your Local Business. Six issues left, plus a bonus issue, every Tuesday morning.

Next up, Part 3, Profiles & Listings. The layer that makes you findable the moment warm becomes searching. Google Business Profile, Apple Maps, Nextdoor, Yelp, and the free channels that compound the longer you tend them.

After that, Events for Awareness, Workshops & Masterclasses, The Local Digital Engine (paid ads, social, retargeting), and Networking, Partnerships & Referrals. The bonus issue, Conversion + Retention, lands the week after the series wraps.

Read the full series at fromthefloorup.co/local

Every issue is a tactical playbook with a downloadable resource. Subscribe and the next one lands in your inbox Tuesday morning.

fromthefloorup.co/local